

Psalms 125

They That Trust in the Lord

They that trust in the Lord shall be as mount Zion, which cannot be removed
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *They that trust in the LORD shall be as mount Zion, which cannot be removed, but abideth for ever.*
- 2 *As the mountains are round about Jerusalem, so the LORD is round about his people from henceforth even for ever.*
- 3 *For the rod of the wicked shall not rest upon the lot of the righteous; lest the righteous put forth their hands unto iniquity.*
- 4 *Do good, O LORD, unto those that be good, and to them that are upright in their hearts.*
- 5 *As for such as turn aside unto their crooked ways, the LORD shall lead them forth with the workers of iniquity: but peace shall be upon Israel.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalms 125 draws its central image directly from the landscape pilgrims would have seen approaching Jerusalem: Zion itself, immovable, and the mountains encircling the city as a natural picture of God's surrounding protection. From that image of stability the psalm moves to a request that the wicked not be allowed to corrupt the righteous through prolonged pressure, and closes with a broader plea for the nation's peace. Henry treats the mountain imagery as intentionally chosen for pilgrims who could see the very hills being described, grounding abstract trust in visible, immediate geography.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

Trust in the Lord is compared directly to Mount Zion: immovable, abiding forever. That stability is reinforced by a second image drawn from the pilgrim's actual view—just as mountains surround Jerusalem, so the Lord surrounds His people, protection pictured as literally encircling rather than merely nearby.

Verse 3

A specific request follows: the rod, or scepter, of the wicked will not remain resting on the lot of the righteous, lest prolonged oppression tempt righteous hands themselves to reach for iniquity—concern here is not only for present suffering but for its potential corrupting influence over time.

Verse 4-5

A closing petition asks God to do good to those who are good and upright in heart, while those who turn aside to crooked ways are led away along with other workers of iniquity—a clear moral fork drawn between two paths. The psalm ends with a brief benediction: peace be upon Israel.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Stability for those who trust in God is pictured as geographically solid and permanently surrounding, like a mountain that cannot be removed and mountains that encircle a city—not a fragile or temporary confidence. Concern for the righteous under prolonged pressure includes not only their present suffering but the real risk that sustained oppression could erode their integrity over time.

Application for life today.

Let the image of Mount Zion—immovable, permanent—reshape how you describe your own trust in God, especially if your current confidence feels shaky rather than solid. If you are under prolonged pressure or opposition, take seriously verse 3's concern that such pressure can corrupt integrity over time, and ask specifically for protection against that erosion, not only relief from the hardship itself. Consider the moral fork named in verse 5—good pursued, crooked ways abandoned—as a deliberate daily choice rather than a settled status you no longer need to examine.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does the image of Mount Zion—immovable and permanent (v. 1)—challenge you to describe your own trust in God as more solid than your current feelings might suggest?

2. If you are under prolonged pressure or opposition, how does verse 3's concern about integrity eroding over time shape what you specifically ask God to protect in you?

3. Where does verse 5's moral fork—between good pursued and crooked ways abandoned—call for a deliberate daily choice rather than an assumption that your character no longer needs examining?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).